Fiscal Year:	FY 2004	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 09/20/2004
PI Name:	Sytkowski, Arthur J. M.D.		
Project Title:	Erythroid Cell Growth And Differentiation In Microgravity		
Division Name:	Space Biology		
Program/Discipline:	SPACE BIOLOGY		
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:	SPACE BIOLOGY--Cellular and molecular biology		
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	None		
Human Research Program Risks:	None		
Space Biology Element:	(1) Cell & Molecular Biology		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	None		
Space Biology Special Category:	(1) Cell Culture		
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Comments:			
Project Type:	Ground	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	2001 Space Biology 01-OBPR-06
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No. of PhD Candidates:	0	**No. of Master' Degrees:**	
No. of Master's Candidates:	0	**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:	0	**Monitoring Center:**	NASA ARC
Contact Monitor:		**Contact Phone:**	
Contact Email:			
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Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:			
COI Name (Institution):			
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	The long-term objective of this research is the study of erythroid cell growth and differentiation in space. We propose to study the effects of microgravity on erythroid cell surface receptors and their interaction with their cognate ligand; receptor-initiated signal transduction; and on the assembly of the cytoskeleton. The work will be done initially through a ground-based experimental approach using the simulated microgravity environment of the NASA-Rotating Wall Vessel bioreactor (RWV), which has already been proven useful in studies of normal and malignant human cell growth and development. This research will serve as a basis for later experiments to be done under the long-term microgravity conditions available aboard the International Space Station. We are studying the effects of modeled microgravity on erythroid cell surface receptors, receptor-initiated signal transduction and on the assembly of the cytoskeleton in order to elucidate how these effects influence cell growth and differentiation. We are testing the following hypotheses. 1.		

Task Description:	Gravitational forces affect the interaction of cell surface erythropoietin receptors with erythropoietin. 2. These changes in receptor function are due, at least in part, to direct effects on receptor distribution, expression and/or protein-protein interactions. 3. Gravitational forces on erythroid cells also affect downstream signaling events both indirectly, due to effects on the erythropoietin receptor, and directly, through forces that modify signaling molecules within the cell. 4. During erythropoietin-induced cell growth and differentiation, gravitational forces modulate the assembly of the cytoskeleton, which is an integral part of terminal differentiation. The experiments are designed to elucidate gravitational effects on signal transduction, gene expression, and differentiation of red blood cell progenitors. Previous experience with our Epo sensitive model erythroid progenitor system and with techniques related to signal transduction and the cytoskeleton and the availability of all required materials and equipment assure that we will be able to achieve the specific aims of the study within three years. Preliminary data we have generated and previously published related work suggest that we will be able to identify and characterize significant effects of shear on signal transduction, gene expression, and differentiation in red blood cell progenitors. The information obtained through this study is likely to be applicable to the anemia associated with space flight and is also likely to be applicable to a wide range of other biologic effects of microgravity, since the processes we propose to study are basic to the functioning of many cell types.
Rationale for HRP Directed Research:	
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	The information obtained through this study is likely to be applicable to the anemia associated with space flight and is also likely to be applicable to a wide range of other biologic effects of microgravity, since the processes we propose to study are basic to the functioning of many cell types. The experiments will further the use of low shear earth-based bioreactors, such as the RWV, in carrying out modeled microgravity experiments on earth, the conclusions of which can be tested and validated on board the ISS. The results of these experiments will have impact on our understanding of erythropoietin receptor function, signal transduction and eukaryotic cell growth and differentiation. Additionally, they will also have important implications for space-based studies of cell and molecular biology. This work will advance the use of the space environment to increase scientific and medical knowledge and to enhance the quality of life on earth.
Task Progress:	We have developed a highly specific and sensitive assay for hemoglobin (Hb), the prime marker of erythroid differentiation, in fixed Rauscher murine erythroleukemia cells (R-cells) ideally suited to space-based research. Cultured R-cells were induced with 50 U Epo/mL or with 0.7% DMSO and were fixed either with 5.8% formalin or with 1.6% paraformaldehyde + 2.4% glutaraldehyde. After removal of fixative, the cells were incubated with tetramethyl benzidine and hydrogen peroxide to generate a chromophore (catalyzed by the “pseudoperoxidase” activity of Hb) measured spectrophotometrically. We found that Hb in R-cells could be measured with a high specificity and sensitivity even after up to four months of fixation. We observed that 1) the absorbance of induced cells was higher ($p<0.05$) than that of non-induced ones; 2) as few as 1 x 105 cells could generate a specific signal; 3) absorbance was directly proportional to cell number and to Hb content; and 4) incubation temperature, fixative type and duration affected chromophore production. This method is directly applicable to studies of erythroid differentiation on orbit.
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 03/08/2019)
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Xu, K.; Feldman, L.; Davis, K.L.; Sytkowski, A.J. "Hydrodynamic shear affects the abundance of erythropoietin receptors and receptor-mediated endocytosis." Forty-Fifth Annual Meeting of the American Society of Hematology. Blood 102(11) Part 2:164b, 2003. , Dec-2003
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Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	Chen, C.; Sytkowski, A.J. "Erythropoietin regulation of Raf-1 and MEK: evidence for a Ras-independent mechanism." Blood 104(1):73-80, Jul 2004. , Jul-2004
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